accountability. Is the allocated amount being spent on the designated item or service? Were the expected outcomes realized? Was the spending wasteful? Did the right people authorize it? Can you show the money trail in a disaster-relief effort? Is the process transparent? Are you able to collect the correct data for demonstrating the effectiveness of the effort? I’m sure you can think of several other similar concerns.

In the following sections, you’ll explore some of these concerns and how they can be addressed by using smart contracts on an infrastructure enabled by the blockchain protocol.

1.4.1 Automatic and consistent data collection

The sustainable development goals of the United Nations General Assembly specify the purposes of UN programs. Your organization likely has similar goals that it hopes to achieve with the budget allocated, and it likely keeps track of the goals and related expenses through various reporting and data collection mechanisms. These are examples of decentralized scenarios in which many centralized computing systems are interacting, but often inefficiently. There is insufficient evidence of the effectiveness of many of the UN’s interventions, for example, due to lack of data or ineffective data collection methods, such as surveys. In this situation, the items of interest could be recorded in the DLT ledger. These items include